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UAE-Starlink
to educate
remote
communities

DUBAI
BY ANUPAM VARMA
News and Business Editor

The UAE has unveiled a new initiative that will see high quality digital education become more accessible to remote and underserved communities worldwide.

This will be made possible following the partnership between The Digital School and Starlink, the satellite internet service, and will target 100 sites in remote areas around the world in the first phase. The project comes with a flexible design that allows for expansion based on impact readiness and effective partnerships.

The partnership, signed on the sidelines of the World Governments Summit 2026, will operate on an integrated model that will combine reliable connectivity with comprehensive digital learning.

Three schools in the Kingdom of Lesotho have already been equipped with Starlink connectivity alongside integrated digital education systems provided by The Digital School.

Dubai launches desert tourism
destination Al Layan Oasis

NEW PROJECT TO FEATURE VAST LAKE, CAMPING ZONES AND SPORTS TRAILS

DUBAI
Gulf News Report

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, announced yesterday the launch of a new large-scale tourism destination, Al Layan Oasis, as part of a Dh4 billion package of green and water-based development projects.

"Al Layan Oasis is a new tourism addition to our economic sector that we have launched today. Spanning 10 million square feet, with a central lake covering 2.5 million square feet, it includes leisure facilities, sports tracks, camping spaces and unprecedented desert tourism experiences, as part of a package of water and green projects for which we have allocated 4 billion dirhams," Sheikh Mohammed wrote on his X account.

'Best quality of life'

"Every day in the UAE is an opportunity to write a new story, plant a new seed, and add a distinct mark on a development



@HHSkMohd

■ The project covering 10 million square feet will be centred on a 2.5 million square feet lake.

journey that creates a better future and ensures the best quality of life in the world," Sheikh Mohammed added.

The project includes the development of integrated infrastructure, 1,000 parking spaces. It also features 14km of walking and cycling tracks, including 4km of elevated paths rising five metres above ground level, offering panoramic views of the oasis and

linking with existing routes in Al Marmoom. The oasis will serve as a key stop along Dubai's caravan route and a distinctive destination located around 50 minutes from the city centre. It is expected to attract 330,000 visitors annually and is divided into four zones:

■ The Gathering Oasis will feature an open-air cinema, amphitheatre, food truck areas, and event spaces.

■ The Family Oasis will offer 28 rest areas, children's play zones, and integrated amenities.

■ The Camping Oasis includes dedicated areas equipped to accommodate 100 caravans, in addition to visitor centre promoting environmental awareness.

■ The Recreation Oasis will provide a range of activities, retail outlets, and services within a sustainable natural setting.

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